Home Emergency Kit Checklist

General safety information, not medical advice or a substitute for training. In an emergency, call 911.

From the free guide at https://jaechung-glitch.github.io/bugout/guides/emergency-kit-list/, which lists its sources. Updated November 9, 2026.

The basic emergency kit

This is the Basic Disaster Supplies Kit from FEMA's Ready.gov, item for item.

- [ ] Water: 1 gallon per person per day, for several days
  For drinking and sanitation. Use our water calculator for your household's total.
- [ ] Food: at least several days of non-perishable food
  Food that needs no fridge and little or no cooking.
- [ ] A battery-powered or hand-crank radio, and a NOAA Weather Radio with tone alert
  For warnings and news when phones and power are down.
- [ ] A flashlight
- [ ] A first-aid kit
- [ ] Extra batteries
- [ ] A whistle
  To signal for help.
- [ ] Dust masks
  To help filter contaminated air.
- [ ] Plastic sheeting, scissors and duct tape
  To shelter in place.
- [ ] Moist towelettes, garbage bags and plastic ties
  For personal sanitation.
- [ ] A wrench or pliers
  To turn off utilities.
- [ ] A manual can opener

- [ ] Local maps
  On paper: your phone may be dead or out of signal.
- [ ] A cell phone with chargers and a backup battery

What to add for your household

FEMA's list of additional supplies covers the things that differ from one family to the next.

HEALTH AND HYGIENE

- [ ] Prescription medicines
- [ ] Non-prescription medicines: pain relievers, anti-diarrhea medicine, antacids or laxatives
- [ ] Prescription glasses and contact lens solution
- [ ] Soap, hand sanitizer and disinfecting wipes
- [ ] Feminine supplies and personal hygiene items

BABIES, CHILDREN AND PETS

- [ ] Infant formula, bottles, diapers, wipes and diaper rash cream
- [ ] Books, games, puzzles or other activities for children
- [ ] Pet food and extra water for your pet

DOCUMENTS AND MONEY

- [ ] Copies of insurance policies, identification and bank account records
  Saved electronically, or in a waterproof container you can carry.
- [ ] Cash or traveler's checks
  Card readers and ATMs need power and a network.
- [ ] Paper and pencil

WARMTH, COOKING AND SAFETY

- [ ] A sleeping bag or warm blanket for each person

- [ ] A complete change of clothing suited to your climate, and sturdy shoes
- [ ] A fire extinguisher
- [ ] Matches in a waterproof container
- [ ] Mess kits, paper cups, plates, paper towels and plastic utensils

Keep it ready

- [ ] Keep canned food in a cool, dry place
- [ ] Store boxed food in tightly closed plastic or metal containers
- [ ] Replace expired items as needed
- [ ] Replace water you bottled yourself every 6 months
- [ ] Rethink your needs every year and update the kit as your family changes

Tick items off on your iPhone. BugOut, the free offline survival app, lets you make your own checklists and keeps its guides on your phone with no signal.